

US to target Mexico, Vietnam on transshipment

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【要点】

- ・トランプ政権はメキシコとベトナムを中国製品の迂回輸出取り締まりの初期対象とする見込みであり、メキシコは中国関連商品の大量輸出国、ベトナムは中国製造業との深い統合が理由である。
- ・USMCA見直しを通じた原産地規則の改革は、中国関連サプライチェーンを持つ企業にとってより大きな長期的リスクとなる可能性がある。
- ・民主党議員フェッターマン上院議員は共和党への鞍替えはしないが、イスラエルや戦争権限などの特定の問題では共和党と共同することがある。
- ・民主党が上院多数派を獲得した場合、フェッターマンは決定的な議席を占め、民主党多数派に対する拒否権を持つことになる可能性がある。

【メール原文】

Mexico and Vietnam likely first targets in US transshipment crackdown . President Donald Trump's administration has recently put in place important el||||||||||||||

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Fetterman could be a wild card, but not a Republican

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US-India trade deal will not be finalized anytime soon

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Manufacturing employment recovery too small to give administration a PR win

Mexico and Vietnam likely first targets in US transshipment crackdown. President Donald Trump's administration has recently put in place important elements of the framework needed to enforce a 40% penalty on the transshipment of Chinese goods established last year.

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Countries exporting large absolute volumes of China-linked goods, such as Mexico, and those with deep integration into Chinese manufacturing, such as Vietnam, will likely be the initial focus of enforcement.

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Rules of origin reform through the ongoing USMCA review poses a bigger long-term risk for companies with China-linked supply chains, as it could disqualify currently legitimate Chinese inputs from preferential tariff treatment.

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For more, please see Mexico and Vietnam likely first targets in US transshipment crackdown , 9 September 2026.

Fetterman could be a wild card, but not a Republican. Senator John Fetterman's (D-PA) video address to the Republicans' midterm convention is the latest instance of him playing a game of his own making, and which only he appears to understand.

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The address doesn't appear to presage Fetterman defecting to the Republican Party after the midterms: He put out a statement last night emphasizing that he still votes with Democrats most of the time in the Senate, and would still be the "51st vote" for Democrats if they win the chamber in November.

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Still, there are likely going to be opportunities for Republicans to peel off Fetterman on individual matters on which he dissents from the Democratic Party's mainstream, especially Israel and war powers. On roughly two dozen occasions in the current Congress, he has been one of only a few Democratic votes alongside Republicans, mostly on nominations, appropriations bills, and war powers.

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If Democrats do win a 51-seat majority, Fetterman will structurally occupy the decisive seat in any case (see Murkowski, Fetterman will be pivotal figures after midterms , 20 May 2026). That will give him de facto veto power, whether he acknowledges it today or not—and Democrats may find he will be a persistent thorn in the side of their potential majority, deepening intra-party divides over issues like the rise of the democratic-socialist wing of the party.

US-India trade deal will not be finalized anytime soon. India is comfortable with the 10% tariff status quo—which excludes 45% of its exports to the US—for now, and has little incentive to rush negotiations. Sectoral deals on energy and defense, alongside Indian investments in the US, have reduced Washington's urgency to finalize a deal.

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Overcapacity tariffs will likely maintain India's tariff advantage over its primary competitors; an 8% overcapacity tariff would raise India's tariff rate to 18%, remaining below China and Vietnam's estimated 20%.

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The US has benefited from Indian efforts to diversify their energy imports away from the Persian Gulf as well as its decision to move ahead with several medium-sized purchases of US arms.

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US tech investments in India also indicate private industry is willing to move ahead without a trade deal in place. Microsoft, Amazon, and Google have committed nearly \$80 billion to build out AI and cloud data center infrastructure in India, and India's restrictions on Chinese digital products make the US tech sector a natural partner.

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For more, see US and India in no hurry to finalize trade deal , 9 September 2026.

Manufacturing employment recovery too small to give administration a PR win. The manufacturing sector added 16,000 jobs in August and 58,000 in 2026, confirming the moderate recovery that JOLTS hires data and the ISM employment index signaled over the summer.

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But the recovery is too small to give the administration a real PR win. Manufacturing-sector payrolls remain roughly 73,000 below January 2025 levels, and manufacturing's employment share has continued to fall; it is now below 8% of the US total.

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Moreover, it's AI and defense demand—not tariff protection—that are driving the manufacturing employment rebound. Computer and electronic products, machinery, and fabricated metals added 42,500 jobs in the year to August on data center and defense investment, while motor vehicles and parts—the most heavily protected part of US manufacturing under the new tariff regime—was flat over the same period and shed 4,500 jobs in August alone. That is consistent with our basecase that tariffs would not lead to a quick reshoring of the production base (see: Auto sector most exposed in prolonged North American trade shift , 30 June 2026).

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Momentum might also be already fading. The ISM employment index fell 1.6 points to 51.2 and new orders dropped 3.0 points to 53.7. Factory construction spending is down 21.9% year over year as CHIPS-funded fabs fade, reducing the stimulus from capital spending.

Quote of the Day

"I would say in the last decade, there's not another Republican who has campaigned for more senators, House members, and gubernatorial candidates than I have." – Senator Ted Cruz in an interview when asked if Vice President JD Vance—who is speaking in the primetime slot of the midterm convention tonight—is the heir apparent of the Republican Party. Against the backdrop of the midterm convention, GOP power players have convened in Dallas to fundraise not only for candidates on the 2026 ballot, but with a view toward 2028 races as well. Cruz is signaling clear interest in running for the Republican presidential nomination and would be perhaps the highest non-administration figure to do so, which could be to his benefit if Trump's popularity among Republican voters falls substantially between now and mid-2027.

On the Radar

10 August – 14 September: Senate on recess

9-10 September: GOP midterms convention

18-28 September: High-Level Week at UN General Assembly

24 September: Trump-Xi summit

3 November: National midterm elections

11 December: Government funding runs out

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